

Digital Transformation — Module 08: Planning —

Discussion Questions

20 questions on transformation roadmapping, change management, sequencing, and digital investment governance.

1. How does GE Digital's \$4B+ failure illustrate the transformation paradox — moving too fast for organizational capacity?
2. How does Kotter's 8-step change model map to Active Inference model updating?
3. When should an organization pursue "big bang" digital transformation versus incremental change?
4. What determines an organization's capacity for digital change? How can it be expanded?
5. How should digital transformation investments be sequenced to maximize learning?
6. Why do most digital transformation initiatives fail? What are the common patterns?
7. How does the Three Horizons framework (McKinsey) help manage digital investment portfolios?
8. When is "digital transformation theater" (appearing to transform without substantial change) occurring?
9. Compare the transformation challenges of a 100-year-old company versus a 10-year-old company.
10. How should boards of directors govern digital transformation investments?
11. Design a digital transformation roadmap for your organization covering 3 years.
12. Apply Kotter's 8 steps to a specific digital transformation initiative in your organization.
13. Identify the biggest barrier to digital transformation in your organization. Is it technology, culture, or skills?
14. Design a "quick win" that would build credibility for a larger digital transformation program.
15. How should organizations measure progress on digital transformation beyond technology deployment?
16. Compare cloud migration, data platform modernization, and AI adoption as transformation priorities. How to sequence?

17. Design a change management program specifically for a digital transformation initiative.
18. How should organizations handle the "frozen middle" — middle managers who resist transformation?
19. When should an organization create a separate digital unit versus integrating digital capability into existing teams?
20. Design a "digital maturity assessment" that evaluates your organization's readiness for transformation.